

M3 The second matrix of the Matrix System

As we already said in the M3 message, we will build the ciphertext matrix, using the same criteria as for the original matrix. We will number the columns from 1 to 31, and the rows from 1 to 14, from N to S for both NK and SK. If in the original matrix in K2 we leave the C of MAGNETIC outside, in the matrix of the ciphertext we will leave out the I that results from its encoding. We will do the same with what we will leave out of K1, whatever our choice, we will leave out the corresponding characters that result from their encoding. The second matrix is the following:

	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19	20	21	22	23	24	25	26	27	28	29	30	31		
	1	E	M	U	F	P	H	Z	L	R	F	A	X	Y	U	S	D	J	K	Z	L	D	K	R	N	S	H	G	N	F	I	V	
	2	J	Y	Q	T	Q	U	X	Q	B	Q	V	Y	U	V	L	L	T	R	E	V	J	Y	Q	T	M	K	Y	R	D	M	F	D
	3	V	F	P	J	U	D	E	E	H	Z	W	E	T	Z	Y	V	G	W	H	K	K	Q	E	T	G	F	Q	J	N	C	E	
	4	G	G	W	H	K	K	?	D	Q	M	C	P	F	Q	Z	D	Q	M	M	I	A	G	P	F	X	H	Q	R	L	G	T	
I	5	M	V	M	Z	J	A	N	Q	L	V	K	Q	E	D	A	G	D	V	F	R	P	J	U	N	G	E	U	N	A	Q	Z	
	6	G	Z	L	E	C	G	Y	U	X	U	E	E	N	J	T	B	J	L	B	Q	C	R	T	B	J	D	F	H	R	R	Y	
	7	I	Z	E	T	K	Z	E	M	V	D	U	F	K	S	J	H	K	F	W	H	K	U	W	Q	L	S	Z	F	T	I	H	
	8	H	D	D	D	U	V	H	?	D	W	K	B	F	U	F	P	W	N	T	D	F	I	Y	C	U	Q	Z	E	R	E	E	
	9	V	L	D	K	F	E	Z	M	O	Q	Q	J	L	T	T	U	G	S	Y	Q	P	F	E	U	N	L	A	V	I	D	X	
	10	F	L	G	G	T	E	Z	?	F	K	Z	B	S	F	D	Q	V	G	O	G	I	P	U	F	X	H	H	D	R	K	F	
	11	F	H	Q	N	T	G	P	U	A	E	C	N	U	V	P	D	J	M	Q	C	L	Q	U	M	U	N	E	D	F	Q	E	
	12	L	Z	Z	V	R	R	G	K	F	F	V	O	E	E	X	B	D	M	V	P	N	F	Q	X	E	Z	L	G	R	E	D	
	13	N	Q	F	M	P	N	Z	G	L	F	L	P	M	R	J	Q	Y	A	L	M	G	N	U	V	P	D	X	V	K	P	D	
	14	Q	U	M	E	B	E	D	M	H	D	A	F	M	J	G	Z	N	U	P	L	G	E	S	W	J	L	L	A	E	T	G	
	1	E	N	D	Y	A	H	R	O	H	N	L	S	R	H	E	O	C	P	T	E	O	I	B	I	D	Y	S	H	N	A	I	
	2	A	C	H	T	N	R	E	Y	U	L	D	S	L	L	S	L	N	O	H	S	N	O	S	M	R	W	X	M	N	E		
	3	T	P	R	N	G	A	T	I	H	N	R	A	R	P	E	S	L	N	E	E	L	E	B	L	P	I	A	C	A	E		
	4	W	M	T	W	N	D	I	T	E	E	N	R	A	H	C	T	E	N	E	U	D	R	E	T	N	H	A	E	O	E	T	
	5	F	O	L	S	E	D	T	I	W	E	N	H	A	E	I	O	Y	T	E	Y	Q	H	E	E	N	C	T	A	Y	C	R	
	6	E	I	F	T	B	R	S	P	A	M	H	H	E	W	E	N	A	T	A	M	A	T	E	G	Y	E	E	R	L	B	T	
	7	E	E	F	O	A	S	F	I	O	T	U	E	T	U	A	E	O	T	O	A	R	M	A	E	E	R	T	N	R	T	I	
	8	B	S	E	D	D	N	I	A	A	H	T	T	M	S	T	E	W	P	I	E	R	O	A	G	R	I	E	W	F	E	B	
	9	A	E	C	T	D	D	H	I	L	C	E	I	H	S	I	T	E	G	O	E	A	O	S	D	D	R	Y	D	L	O	R	
	10	I	T	R	K	L	M	L	E	H	A	G	T	D	H	A	R	D	P	N	E	O	H	M	G	F	M	F	E	U	H	E	
	11	E	C	D	M	R	I	P	F	E	I	M	E	H	N	L	S	S	T	T	R	T	V	D	O	H	W	?	O	B	K	R	
	12	U	O	X	O	G	H	U	L	B	S	O	L	I	F	B	B	W	F	L	R	V	Q	Q	P	R	N	G	K	S	S	O	
	13	T	W	T	Q	S	J	Q	S	S	E	K	Z	Z	W	A	T	J	K	L	U	D	I	A	W	I	N	F	B	N	Y	P	
	14	V	T	T	M	Z	F	P	K	W	G	D	K	Z	X	T	J	C	D	I	G	K	U	H	U	A	U	E	K	C	A	R	

What new things can we see in the ciphertext matrix we have built? In addition to the big clue in plain sight that we discussed in the M1 message: OHNNY NASH, I SEE, LINE BLUE, some more words appear: TAIL, BEEF, DART, ENDS, MATE, POET, PIER, TREE... just random? And also two queens with mistakes: XUEEN and QHEEN. The second QHEEN is formed with the final Q of K3. If it's deliberate, some QUEEN is involved in Kryptos. But there are 3 words that seem relevant to me: In column 16, row 3 from N to S in SK: STONE. And aligned, one with another, in column 14, rows 9 and 10 from W to E in SK the already known ones: SITE and HARD. A total of 13 characters... just random? When I had the pleasure of meeting Elonka in December 2005, I told her that we could get ABSCISSA from Morse Code K0 (message #3952 and following) and 40% from PALIMPSEST and K1 by testing PALINDROME as key (message #3967). Now when I see STONE, SITE and HARD the first phrase that comes to my mind is: BETWEEN A ROCK AND A HARD PLACE. If we try with this phrase as a key in Kryptos we get 70% of PALIMPSEST

(PALIMPS), because BETWEEN is the first word of the plain text of K1. Is this enough for the operative in the field to recognize PALIMPSEST?

From her interview with Ed in Feb 2011, Elonka tells us: He talked about how it was a code that could be solved without giving away who'd solve it. That clue was not understood. Perhaps it would be better to have expressed: without leaving aside who'd solve it. Ed began to talk, repeatedly, that the message is intended for an operative in the field under duress (with a gun to his head), that is why there are duress ciphers, and that they are difficult to design. He has insisted a lot on this, so it must be important. Jim and Ed have already given us at least two examples of duress ciphers: with the same ciphertext and different keys we get different plaintext: "ID BY ROWS" / "LAYER TWO" in K3 and "T THE KEY e TRANS" / "TWENTY StCONDS" in Pre-Kryptos. In the first 8 character example there are no errors, it is perfect. As we'll see later, ID BY ROWS is as important clue in K4 as LAYER TWO. In the second example of 13 characters there is only one error in each message.

The phrase BETWEEN A ROCK AND A HARD PLACE also conveys the idea of being under duress. The operative in the field must choose between delivering the message to his captor and having his head shot. And also if the TEE in column 15 row 8 from W to E and the E of STONE from S to N indicates your position (T IS YOUR POSITION), then you are literally BETWEEN A STONE AND A HARD SITE, that is, BETWEEN A ROCK AND A HARD PLACE and under duress, such as the operative in the field. I think this is the clue in Kryptos, of what Ed has told us so many times: the message is intended for an operative in the field under duress, with a gun to his head. In Spanish the expression is: ENTRE LA ESPADA Y LA PARED (BETWEEN THE SWORD AND THE WALL) Instead of a gun, it is a sword. What can the operative do to save his life and not deliver the message? Well, if it is a duress cipher, he delivers the key 1 and the message 1 (LAYER ONE). Key 2 and message 2 remain hidden (LAYER TWO).

This matrix with the ciphertext does not seem to add much new information but, as we will see later, it is as important as the original, to build the matrix system that Jim talks about, walk the trail of doorways that he has promised us and enjoy new moments of discovery linked to K4 and K5.

There is much, much more!

Jose Luis